

FORTUNE F. THOBELA

BSc Student | Aspiring Software Engineer/Data Engineer

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SUMMARY

I am a final year BSc Information Technology (Computer Science and Informatics) student at the University of Johannesburg and a 2023 UJenius Academic Award recipient. I combine a strong academic foundation in software development with hands-on experience guiding peers through programming logic and algorithmic problem-solving. I am proficient in object-oriented programming, data structures, and foundational coding in Java, C++, C#, JavaScript, and Python. As an aspiring Data Engineer, I am dedicated to expanding my technical foundations to design efficient, scalable data architectures and robust software systems that support data-driven decision-making

EXPERIENCE

QYF Virtual Internship, QuantifyYourFuture | Powered by SAGEA | Jan 2026 - Feb 2026

- Acquired real-world work experience through projects with Absa, FirstRand, FNB, Nedbank and Standard Bank
- Gained hands-on exposure to data analysis including framing, exploration, interpretation, modelling and visualisation
- Strengthened key professional skills, including critical thinking, creativity, collaboration, and communication.
- Collaborated on team-based projects facilitated by leading financial institutions, applying data-driven solutions

Computer Science 1 Student Assistant, University of Johannesburg | Feb 2026 - Present

- Provided practical support to students during practical sessions, resolving issues related to software and programming practicals.
- Evaluated, debugged, and graded weekly software submissions for Computer Science 1 students, ensuring compliance with object-oriented programming standards and data structure logic.

Volunteer Tutor, ClassroomBuddies Organization | Feb 2024 - Present

- Deliver one-on-one and group tutoring sessions in Mathematics and Physical Sciences. Break down complex concepts into simpler, learner-friendly explanations.
- Track learner progress and adapt teaching strategies to meet individual needs. Contributed over 180 volunteer hours to the organization

IT Vacation Student, Cell C | June 2026 - July 2026

- Actively bridging the gap between computer science/informatics academic theory and fast-paced, practical industry environments.
- Collaborating with and learning from cross-functional technical teams to understand system design, security protocols, and modern tech stacks at scale.
- Developing an understanding of how organizational vision and mission translate into technical requirements, resource management, and robust digital solutions.
- Unpacking large-scale corporate IT infrastructure, workflows, and operational methodologies used to support millions of active users.

EDUCATION

BSc in Infor Tech Computer Science and Informatics | Jan 2023 - Dec 2026

University of Johannesburg

- Year of Study: Final Year
- Ujenius Award (2023) - Top 1% of academic achievers

Matric (Grade 12) | Jan 2018 - December 2022

Sidlamafa Secondary School

- Science and Mathematics

SKILLS

- Programming Languages: Java, C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, C#, SQL
- Frameworks & Libraries: Node.js, Express.js, Spring Boot, React
- Databases: SQL Server, MySQL, MongoDB
- Tools & DevOps: Git, GitHub, Docker, VS Code
- Methodologies: Agile/Scrum, Object-Oriented Design (OOD), Data Modeling, Relational Database Design

Final Year Projects

Tile Detector: *Assistive Graph-Based Navigation & Computer Vision System* | Java, Python,SQLITE, GCNNs, Graph ADTs, Hashed Dictionaries, Custom Trees | Mar 2026 – May 2026

- Collaborated in a development team to build an assistive navigation system, taking personal ownership of the core data tier by engineering Graph Abstract Data Types (ADTs), hashed dictionaries, and custom tree structures from scratch in Java.
- Designed and executed the team's data extraction and pre-processing pipeline natively in Java, ensuring optimized memory allocation and processing speeds.
- Contributed to the integration of a Python-based Graph Convolutional Neural Network (GCNN) by linking its image classification model directly to the structural features and metadata extracted natively in Java.

EduBridge Platform: *ClassRoom Buddies Organisation (In Progress)* | TypeScript, Node.js, Express, Prisma, MYSQL, Supabase, Git | Mar 2026 – Present

- Collaborating in a team to build a modular system featuring multiple integrated subsystems to consolidate and digitize an NPO's (ClassRoomBuddies Organisation) disconnected paperwork, documentation, and manual tracking workflows.
- Designed a centralized relational database schemas to structurally unify operational data, eliminating systemic data silos and significantly improving administrative tracking efficiency.
- Automating manual day-to-day administrative processes into streamlined digital pipelines, directly enhancing the organization's overall operational effectiveness and data management.

References

Provided upon request.